

VIFM COMPETENCY-BASED INTERVIEW (CBI) · REPORT

Candidate A (anonymised)

Senior Finance Manager · Sample Client · Interviewed 28 September 2026

What this report is. Evidence from a structured, two-hour behavioural interview on six competencies from the VIFM Competency Framework, rated against anchored scales by two trained interviewers and calibrated. **What it is not.** A hiring decision, a measure of technical knowledge, or a prediction on its own. Read it alongside the other evidence the panel holds.

Summary

COMPETENCY	RATING	TARGET	RATING AGAINST TARGET	READ
Critical Analysis & Judgement Thinking · Above requirement	4	4.0		At target
Strategic & Commercial Insight Thinking · Meets requirement	3	3.5		Below target
Delivery & Accountability Results · Above requirement	4	4.0		At target
Influence & Agreement People · Meets requirement	3	3.5		Below target
Coaching & Talent Growth People · Development needed	2	3.5		Clear gap
Resilience & Composure Self · Above requirement	4	3.5		Above target

Bar shows the rating on the 1 to 5 scale; the dark marker is the role target from the role profile. Ratings are the agreed ratings after calibration.

INDICATIVE OVERALL READ

3.3 mean of six

Meets the role requirement overall, with clear strength in delivery and composure and one competency well below target. The mean is a convenience; the panel should weigh the high-priority competencies.

HEADLINE STRENGTHS

- ✓ Critical Analysis & Judgement
- ✓ Delivery & Accountability
- ✓ Resilience & Composure

DEVELOPMENT AREAS

- ⊖ Coaching & Talent Growth (2 against 3.5)
- ⊖ Strategic & Commercial Insight (3 against 3.5)
- ⊖ Influence & Agreement (3 against 3.5)

INTERVIEW RECORD

Date	28 September 2026	Interviewer	Lead interviewer: VIFM consultant
Duration	120 minutes, as planned	Interviewer	Second interviewer: client HR business partner
Guide	Senior Finance Manager, version SFM-01, standard question set	Calibration	Ratings agreed in a calibration discussion immediately after the interview.

Anchor for a 4. Quickly distinguishes critical from peripheral information, uncovers hidden problems, and weighs multiple competing explanations before deciding. Makes sound decisions under pressure, anticipates second-order consequences, and defends choices with well-structured reasoning that withstands scrutiny.

WHAT THE CANDIDATE DESCRIBED

Two strong examples of getting beneath reported figures. In the first, a working-capital variance of around 12% that the business had attributed to timing was traced to a change in supplier payment terms that had not been approved; the candidate rebuilt the cash forecast and took a corrected position to the CFO within the week. In the second, a business case for a new system was challenged on an unrealistic benefits ramp, which the candidate reworked with the sponsor rather than rejecting outright. Decisions were timely and the candidate stood behind them under probing. Evidence of weighing second-order consequences was present but less developed in the second example.

+ INDICATORS OBSERVED

- ✓ Identified underlying causes behind reported figures
- ✓ Identified weaknesses in a proposal others had accepted
- ✓ Decided without unnecessary delay

− GAPS IN THE EVIDENCE

- − Second-order consequences considered mainly when prompted

↗ TO BUILD ON

- ⊙ When faced with a complex problem, resist jumping to solutions. Use a structured frame: define the problem, gather data from more than one source, identify root causes, generate alternatives and evaluate trade-offs before deciding.

Anchor for a 3. Articulates how current market trends affect the business and connects proposed actions to revenue or cost drivers. Explains priorities with clear rationale that balances immediate needs with longer-term commercial objectives in an understandable way.

WHAT THE CANDIDATE DESCRIBED

The candidate reads the business well and links finance work to revenue and cost drivers, with a clear example of reframing a pricing discussion around margin rather than volume. Examples of anticipating external shifts were thinner: the regulatory change example was reactive, with the candidate responding well once it landed rather than ahead of it. Long-term framing was present but the candidate tended to return to the next budget cycle as the horizon.

+ INDICATORS OBSERVED

- ✓ Connected proposed actions to revenue and cost drivers
- ✓ Prioritised financial considerations when deciding

− GAPS IN THE EVIDENCE

- − Anticipating market or regulatory shifts before they land
- − Framing beyond the annual cycle

↗ SUGGESTED DEVELOPMENT

- ⊙ Before any significant decision, write down the three-year impact and connect the action to a strategic objective.
- ⊙ Set aside thirty minutes a week for industry and regional economic reports, and bring three implications for the organisation to the leadership team.

Delivery & Accountability

RATING

4

Above requirement

TARGET

4.0

At target

Anchor for a 4. Proactively updates others on progress, meets demanding deadlines while maintaining quality standards, openly admits errors and immediately proposes corrective actions that address root causes effectively.

WHAT THE CANDIDATE DESCRIBED

Consistent evidence of delivering under fixed deadlines without letting standards slip, including a year-end close completed on time after the loss of two team members, with the candidate personally covering reconciliations and flagging the risk to the CFO ten days ahead. When an intercompany error reached the audit committee, the candidate owned it in the meeting, explained the fix and the control change, and did not deflect to the team. The example of a missed commitment was candid and showed early communication.

+ INDICATORS OBSERVED

- ✓ Met demanding deadlines while maintaining quality
- ✓ Flagged delivery risk before it landed
- ✓ Owned an error openly and fixed the root cause

↗ TO BUILD ON

- ⊙ At the start of every project or meeting, state who owns what by when, write it down and follow up. Make accountability visible, not punitive.

- GAPS IN THE EVIDENCE

None of note. Evidence was specific, personal and consistent across the three questions.

Influence & Agreement

RATING

3

Meets requirement

TARGET

3.5

Below target

Anchor for a 3. Builds logical cases using relevant facts and data tailored to the audience. Addresses objections calmly and directly, keeping discussions focused on issues rather than personalities. Reaches fair agreements through balanced trade-offs that meet core objectives.

WHAT THE CANDIDATE DESCRIBED

The candidate builds a logical, data-led case and gave a good example of winning a cost-control decision with a reluctant operations head by reframing it around the head's own service targets. In the disagreement example, however, the candidate conceded on a control point to preserve the relationship and later had to revisit it. Saying no to a senior stakeholder was handled respectfully but the case leaned on policy rather than on the stakeholder's interests.

+ INDICATORS OBSERVED

- ✓ Developed logical arguments from facts and data
- ✓ Addressed disagreement calmly, kept it on the issue

- GAPS IN THE EVIDENCE

- ⊙ Holding firm on what matters under senior pressure
- ⊙ Framing the case around the other party's interests rather than policy

↗ SUGGESTED DEVELOPMENT

- ⊙ Before any proposal, map each stakeholder's priorities and concerns and frame the case in terms of what matters to them.
- ⊙ When you meet resistance, ask questions rather than push harder. "Help me understand your concern" opens doors.

Coaching & Talent Growth

RATING

2

Development needed

TARGET

3.5

Clear gap

Anchor for a 2. Gives feedback occasionally but lacks specificity or timeliness. Recognises some development needs when prompted but provides limited guidance on how to address them or pursue growth opportunities.

WHAT THE CANDIDATE DESCRIBED

Development evidence was limited. The candidate described a strong analyst who was promoted, but the candidate's own contribution was mainly to recommend the promotion; structured feedback, stretch assignments or development conversations were not described. The difficult-feedback example was deferred for several months until an appraisal, and the stretch-assignment example was a task delegated for capacity reasons with no follow-up. The candidate was open about this being an area they have not prioritised.

+ INDICATORS OBSERVED

- Identified strength in a team member accurately

- GAPS IN THE EVIDENCE

- Timely, specific feedback
- Delegation for growth with support and follow-up
- Regular development conversations

↗ SUGGESTED DEVELOPMENT

- Hold a monthly development conversation with each direct report, separate from performance reviews: what do you want to learn, where do you want to be in two years, how can I help.
- Delegate for development, not only for efficiency. Assign stretch tasks that build capability and accept that they take longer at first.

Resilience & Composure

RATING

4

Above requirement

TARGET

3.5

Above target

Anchor for a 4. Stays composed under significant pressure, with sharp focus and constructive responses. Rebounds quickly from a setback, names what can be learned from it and reorganises the remaining work to recover lost ground.

WHAT THE CANDIDATE DESCRIBED

Clear, specific evidence of composure under combined pressure: a year-end that coincided with a regulator information request and a system outage. The candidate described re-sequencing the work, protecting the team's hours and keeping the CFO informed daily, and could name what it cost them personally. The public-challenge example from an audit committee member was handled calmly in the moment, with a follow-up the next day. Energy management was described in practical terms, including boundaries the team could see.

+ INDICATORS OBSERVED

- Remained calm and objective under pressure
- Kept the team steady and sequenced the work
- Modelled sustainable practice for the team

- GAPS IN THE EVIDENCE

None of note. Evidence was specific, personal and consistent across the three questions.

↗ TO BUILD ON

- Build a personal reset for high-pressure moments, such as a breathing routine or stepping away briefly, and practise it in low-stakes settings so it is automatic when it counts.

Decision integration

The panel completes this section. The interview provides one line of evidence; the recommendation is the panel's, not the report's.

SOURCE	SIGNAL
Competency-based interview	Mean 3.3 of 5. Above target on Resilience & Composure; at target on Critical Analysis & Judgement and Delivery & Accountability; below target on Strategic & Commercial Insight and Influence & Agreement; clear gap on Coaching & Talent Growth.
Technical assessment	Enter the result of the technical or knowledge assessment, if used.
Other evidence	References, work samples, prior assessment data, self-report instruments.
Panel notes	
Overall recommendation	AdvanceHoldDeclineAdvance with development plan

Suggested development plan, if appointed

PRIORITY	COMPETENCY	FIRST ACTIONS
1	Coaching & Talent Growth 2 against 3.5	- Hold a monthly development conversation with each direct report, separate from performance reviews: what do you want to learn, where do you want to be in two years, how can I help. - Delegate for development, not only for efficiency. Assign stretch tasks that build capability and accept that they take longer at first.
2	Strategic & Commercial Insight 3 against 3.5	- Before any significant decision, write down the three-year impact and connect the action to a strategic objective. - Set aside thirty minutes a week for industry and regional economic reports, and bring three implications for the organisation to the leadership team.
3	Influence & Agreement 3 against 3.5	- Before any proposal, map each stakeholder's priorities and concerns and frame the case in terms of what matters to them. - When you meet resistance, ask questions rather than push harder. "Help me understand your concern" opens doors.

Using this report

HOW THE RATINGS WERE PRODUCED

Two trained interviewers asked the standard question set for the role, recorded the candidate's examples, classified the evidence against the framework's behavioural indicators after the interview, rated each competency against its anchors, and agreed the ratings in a calibration discussion. Structured interviews of this kind are among the better predictors of job performance (Schmidt and Hunter, 1998), and roughly twice as predictive as unstructured interviews.

LIMITS AND CANDIDATE RIGHTS

The interview measures behaviour the candidate chose to describe; it does not measure technical knowledge, reasoning ability or how the candidate performs when observed, which other instruments cover. Ratings relate to this role's targets and should not be reused for another role without review. The candidate is entitled to a summary of strengths and development areas, and may raise a query about the process within 21 days of receiving the outcome. The report is confidential to the client and is retained under the client agreement.

This is an illustrative sample. The candidate, client and evidence are fictional. Framework content: VIFM Competency Framework v2.